[Metric]
A-A-2755A
May 13, 1996
Superseding
A-A-2755
December 30, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
PENCILS, COLORED LEAD

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description, for use by all federal agencies.

1. Scope: This Commercial Item Description covers non-mechanical waxed based, lead colored pencils for obtaining water-fast and light-fast markings.

2. Classification:

Types: I - Thin Lead
II - Thick Lead

3. Salient Characteristics:

3.1 Each lead shall be furnished in one piece, except in pencils ha ing any combination of two colors, and shall be of such material as to produce smooth, even and uniform writing.

3.2 Leads shall be centered within the casing and securely bonded (glued) to the casing throughout the entire length in accordance with normal commercial practice. The lead shall be furnished in colors as specified, and if required shall be provided in sets of colors as specified in the ordering information.

3.3 When sharpened the wood casing shall not split, splinter or tear, shall present a smooth finish, and the lead shall not crumble or dust. Additionally, the pencil length shall be not less than 17.8 cm ± .6 cm (7 inches ± .25 inches).

3.4 If required, erasers shall be provided in accordance with the latest version of commercial item description A-A-132 (type I only). Pencils shall be marked with the manufacturer's name or trademark, and color number.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to General Services Administration, Federal Supply Service, Engineering Division, 26 Federal Plaza, New York, NY 10278.

FSC 7510

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3.5 The case and lead colors shall be imprinted with any other identifying markings consistent with normal commercial practices.

3.6 The diameter of the round pencil shall not be less than .74 cm (.290 inches) nor more than .8 cm (.315 inches). The thickness of the hexagonal pencil, measured across flats, shall be not less than .7 cm (.265 inches) nor more than .78 cm (.295 inches) see table I.

Table I.

Relative Thickness	Lead Diameter (Range cm/inches)
Thin	.23 to .30 - (.0905 to .118)
Thick	.32 to .40 - (.125 to .150)
Diameter shall be uniform throughout the entire length of the lead	

3.7 The coloring shall consist essentially of pigments with or without dyes as required. The lead shall not contain aniline or other dyes which are water soluble and can be absorbed by paper.

3.8 The pencil vendor shall certify the following by published data for the vendors supplier for the pencil leads.

3.8.1 Wax content shall not be more than 35 % by weight of the lead when tested, breaking strength shall average not less than 850 grams, all colors shall be fast to water (65° F ± 5° F) and shall not smear, and shall be fast to light.

3.9 Workmanship. Pencils shall be clean and free from splits, splinters, blisters and any other defects which adversely affect appearance, serviceability or performance.

4. Regulatory Requirements: The offerer/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23.403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. Quality Assurance Requirements:

5.1 Product Conformance. The products provided shall meet the salient characteristics of this commercial item description, conform to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards and quality assurance practices and be the same product offered for sale in the commercial market. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance.

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5.2 **Examination and Testing.**

5.2.1 Suppliers are encouraged to use quality control (QC) techniques that exhibit control over their processes (e.g. (Statistical Process Control) SPC techniques) as defined in American National Standards Institute (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2 and Z1.3/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) B.1, B.2 and B.3 that systematically reduce excess variations. If used, objective evidence shall be available that demonstrates overall measurement adequacy techniques and controls. These techniques shall ensure quality levels equal to, or greater than, those cited in applicable technical document or, herein.

5.2.2 End item inspection/testing may be used by the offeror or the Government representative, as a means to determine the effectiveness of the in process quality controls. While in process controls shall not be substituted for end item performance testing they may be used in lieu of visual and dimensional sampling.

5.2.3 For those characteristics for which there are no such controls, or for end item performance test, lot by lot sampling for inspection/test shall be required. The sample unit shall be one pencil. Sampling shall be in accordance with the American National Standards Institute (ANSI)/ American Society for Quality Control (ASQC) Z1.4, Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

5.2.4 An inspection lot shall consist of all like items submitted for inspection at one time. The inspection level for visual and dimensional defects shall be S-1 with an AQL of 4.0 percent. The supplier must provide objective evidence (tests and inspection records) that the presented material meets the requirements of the sampling plan as indicated above.

6. **Packaging:**

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking shall be specified in the contract or order.

7. **Notes:**

7.1 **Source of Documents.** Issues of the following documents, in effect on the date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of this document to the extent specified herein.

7.1.1 Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) may be obtained from the Superintendent of Documents, Government Printing Office, Washington. DC 20402.

7.1.2 Application for copies of (ANSI) Z1.1, Z1.2, Z1.3 and (ASQC) B.1, B.2, and B.3 may be obtained from the American Society for Quality Control. PO Box 3005, 611 E. Wisconsin Avenue, Milwaukee, WI 53201-4606.

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7.2 National Stock Number Listing (NSN). The following is a list of NSN's assigned which correspond to this CID. The list may not be indicative of all possible NSN's associated with the CID.

Pencil, Colored Lead

7510-00-164-8926	7510-00-286-5784
7510-00-174-3204	7510-01-050-2557
7510-00-192-7576	7510-01-050-2558
7510-00-264-4608	7510-01-050-2562
7510-00-264-4609	7510-01-050-2562
7510-00-264-4610	7510-01-050-2564
7510-00-268-9460	7510-01-050-2566
7510-00-269-8085	7510-01-050-2567
7510-00-281-5237	7510-01-050-9938
7510-00-282-6181	7510-01-060-1632
7510-00-285-5832	7510-01-060-5893
7510-01-060-5896	

Pencil, Colored Lead, Assortment

7510-01-027-1616
7510-01-060-5893
7510-01-060-5896
7510-00-205-0805
7510-00-285-5827
7510-00-286-5764

MILITARY INTERESTS:

NONE: DoD has no registered interest in revisions and amendments to this Commercial Item Description until further notice.

Preparing Activity:

GSA-FSS

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